

Handling your first Zillow lead

90 minutes including practice · 35 screens

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Conversation starters to keep beside you

Choose what fits the conversation. You do not need to ask every question. Start with what the buyer already told you and follow their answers.

Open the conversation

- What made you click on this particular home?
- Have you had a chance to look at other homes in the market?
- What other homes have you been considering?
- What have you liked or disliked about the homes you've seen?
- Is this your first home purchase, or have you bought before?

Understand what matters

- Where are you moving from?
- Which areas are you considering, and what draws you to them?
- What is working well in your current home?
- What would you like your next home to do differently?
- What prompted you to start looking?
- What would that extra space let you do?

Explore timing and decisions

- What timing would work best for you?
- What needs to happen before you can make a move?
- Who else would you like involved in looking at homes or making the decision?

Follow an answer

- Tell me more about that.
- What makes that important to you?
- What would that change for you?
- What would help you feel comfortable with the next step?

When a buyer raises a concern

- Acknowledge the concern: recognize the worry or frustration before moving on.

- Ask questions to understand: What part concerns you most? What happened before? What would you need to know?
- Offer a solution: propose a specific action tied to their answer, then check whether it would help.

Useful next steps may include verifying property information, comparing homes, arranging lender help when the buyer raises financing, or agreeing on a later conversation. Be accurate about your role, property status, and what you can promise. Respect the buyer's decision.

Your Day 2 teaching reference

Use these explanations and demonstrations after class. Follow the four sections to find the task you need. Complete interactive record practice in Rep. Fictional examples illustrate the steps.

Handling your first Zillow lead

Day 2 · 90 minutes including discussion and practice

Learn how to respond to the lead, lead the first conversation, and agree on a useful next step with the buyer.

What you will learn and practice

For each topic, share your thinking first. Then study the explanation and practice the approach.

- 01Recognize the lead and respondIdentify the request before choosing your first action.
- 02Open the first conversationIntroduce yourself and invite the appointment early.
- 03Understand what the buyer needsUse each answer to choose a useful follow-up question.
- 04Work through concerns and agree on the next stepUnderstand the reason, offer useful help, and summarize the agreement.

Recognize the lead and respond

Identify the request before choosing your first action.

01

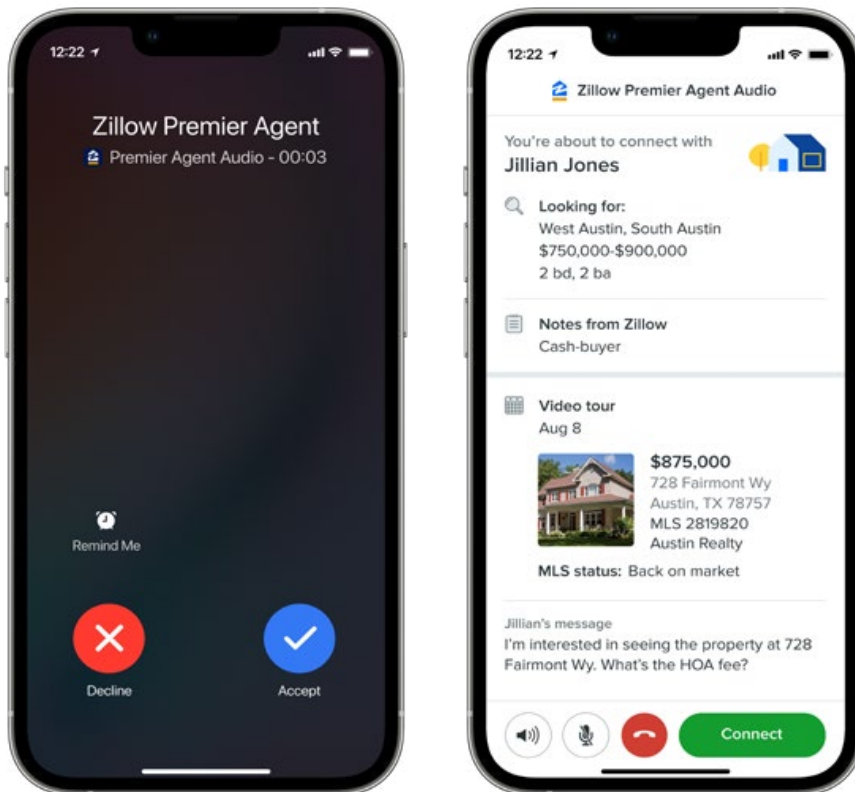
Discuss your approach

Learn the steps

Put it into practice

A live connection puts a buyer on the phone

Zillow calls you first. You review the inquiry, then connect to the waiting buyer.



Answer the incoming call. Zillow provides information about the buyer and the home before you speak to the buyer.

Read the inquiry, then connect. In this example, the buyer asks about a property's HOA fee. Begin by introducing yourself and acknowledging that question.

Source: Zillow Conversion Playbook, page 7. Zillow's published demonstration; screens vary by app version.

Real-Time Touring asks you to accept a tour

The phone alert identifies Real-Time Touring. The app then shows the buyer's requested times.



Review the request in the app. Zillow gives you five minutes to accept a time you can attend or pass on the request.

This is not a live buyer transfer. After accepting, review the booking details and contact the buyer about the appointment.

Source: Zillow Real-Time Touring demonstration. Zillow's published demonstration; screens vary by app version.

A standard tour request tells you what the buyer wants

The buyer has asked to see a particular home. They may have supplied a preferred day and time.

Read the request before you contact them. Use the property and preferred time in your opening so the buyer does not have to start over.

"I see you requested a tour Saturday afternoon. Would that still work for you? I'll check the showing arrangements and confirm the details."

A standard tour request may arrive as a live connection or an alert in Follow Up Boss. If the buyer is not already on the phone, your next job is to contact them.

Call promptly when the buyer has asked to hear from you

For a new lead received during normal business hours, 8 a.m.-8 p.m., call within five minutes unless the buyer gave a different contact instruction.

The buyer just asked for help with a home. A call lets you hear their tone, answer questions as they arise, and begin a conversation about what they need.

Follow Up Boss may already have sent an automated introduction. That does not replace your own call. If the buyer requested a later callback or asked for text, respect that instruction.

If the call goes unanswered, send a personal text

Example: a buyer requested a tour of 418 Cedar Lane. You just called, but they did not answer. The address is fictional.

"Hi, this is [your name] with [your brokerage]. I just tried calling about your Zillow request to see 418 Cedar Lane. I'd be happy to help arrange a tour. I'm available for a call at 4 or 6 today. Would either time work for you?"

Tell them who called, connect the call to their request, and offer a clear opportunity to talk. Use times you can actually make. You are offering a phone call here, not confirming a tour.

Keep working a new lead that has not answered

The first missed call and personal text are the beginning of your outreach, not the entire plan.

Day one: Aim for three to four personal touches, with at least two calls and one personal text in the normal unanswered-lead flow.

First week: Aim for ten total touches, including day one. Make most attempts calls, vary the contact times, and make each text relevant to the inquiry.

Once the buyer responds: Follow the conversation and the plan you agree together. The unanswered-lead quota no longer applies. Honor stated contact restrictions throughout.

Open the first conversation

Introduce yourself and invite the appointment early.

02

Discuss your approach

Learn the steps

Put it into practice

Use LEAD to guide the conversation

Introduce yourself. Ask for the appointment. Learn what matters. Confirm the plan.

- **L - Lead with who you are:** Introduce yourself: your name, brokerage, connection to Zillow, and why you're calling.
- **E - Extend the invitation:** Immediately after your introduction, ask for the appointment. Offer the buyer two concrete times to meet with you.
- **A - Ask questions that move the conversation forward:** Ask where they want to live, what prompted their search, and what matters to them. Use their answers to ask the next useful question.
- **D - Deliver the summary:** Summarize what matters to the buyer, confirm the next steps, and build momentum toward the appointment.

You may also know Zillow's ALMS: Appointment, Location, Motivation, Summarize. LEAD includes your introduction and uses location and motivation to guide your questions.

Demonstration: introduce yourself and offer the visit

Practice buyer George requested a tour of 418 Cedar Lane through Zillow. No time was selected. You can meet Saturday morning or afternoon; property access still needs checking.

Agent “Hi George, I’m [your name] with [your brokerage], a featured partner with Zillow. I’m calling about your request to see 418 Cedar Lane.”

Agent “I can meet Saturday morning or afternoon. Which would work better for you? I’ll check access for that time.”

George “Saturday morning would be good.”

Understand what the buyer needs

Use each answer to choose a useful follow-up question.

03

Discuss your approach

Learn the steps

Put it into practice

Questions you can use to start a conversation

Choose a question that fits what the buyer has already told you. Use the answer to decide what to ask next.

- What made you click on this particular home?
- Have you had a chance to look at other homes in the market?
- What other homes have you been considering?
- Where are you moving from?
- Which areas are you considering, and what draws you to them?
- What would you like your next home to do differently?
- What prompted you to start looking?
- Is this your first home purchase, or have you bought before?
- What timing would work best for you?
- What have you liked or disliked about the homes you’ve seen?

Go deeper: “Tell me more about that.” · “What makes that important to you?” · “What would that change for you?”

Follow the answer before choosing a feature

Fictional conversation after the appointment invitation.

Agent asks

“What would the extra space let you do?”

Buyer explains

“I take work calls at the kitchen table. Everyone has to stay quiet.”

Agent follows up

“Would a separate room solve that, or do you also need distance from the main living area?”

Agent checks

“So being able to close a door and take calls matters more than the total square footage. Have I understood that?”

Work through concerns and agree on the next step

Understand the reason, offer useful help, and summarize the agreement.

04

Discuss your approach

Learn the steps

Put it into practice

Common objections you may hear

Different words can hide very different concerns. Start by understanding what is behind the buyer's hesitation.

- “I only had a question about the home.”
- “I’m not ready to buy yet.”
- “I’m uncertain about the market.”
- “I’m worried about the monthly payment.”
- “We need to sell our home first.”
- “The home I wanted is already under contract.”
- “I only want to speak with the listing agent.”
- “I don’t want to commit to an agent yet.”

Which have you heard? What did the buyer actually need help understanding?

Understand the concern before offering help

Help the buyer work through the concern. Do not rush past it to get back to your script.

- **Acknowledge the concern:** Recognize what feels difficult or uncertain. “I hear you - this is a big decision.”
- **Ask questions to understand:** Find out what is underneath it. “What part is worrying you most?” Then follow their answer.
- **Offer a solution:** Propose a specific next step that addresses what you learned. Explain how it helps, then ask, “Would that be useful?”

An objection is not resolved just because you delivered a response. Listen to whether the proposed next step actually helps.

“I’m uncertain about the market right now.”

Example: the buyer is interested in the home but hesitates when you offer an appointment. Find out what is behind the concern before offering a solution.

Acknowledge “I hear you. It’s a big decision, and you want to feel comfortable with it.”

Ask “What is worrying you most about buying right now?”

Buyer “I’m worried we’ll rush and choose the wrong home.”

Offer a solution “We can use a visit to learn what works for you and compare it with other options. You don’t have to decide to buy today. Would seeing it with that purpose help?”

Summarize the buyer’s priorities and the plan

Return to practice buyer George: he wants a shorter commute and garden space. He prefers Saturday morning for Cedar Lane and has agreed to compare another home. Access is still pending.

“You’d like a shorter commute and a sunny space for a vegetable garden. We’re aiming for Saturday morning. I’ll check access to Cedar Lane and research another home to compare. I’ll text you the confirmed details once I have them. Have I understood everything correctly?”

Before ending, confirm the communication plan and explain the applicable touring form. Describe its actual terms and what the buyer will receive.

Save the details that make your next contact useful

Example: after the practice call, George wants a shorter commute and a sunny garden. Saturday morning is preferred; access and a comparison home still need checking.

FUB note: Rents locally. Wants a shorter commute near Cedar Lane and sun for raised vegetable beds. Open to another home for comparison. Prefers Saturday morning. Text is the agreed channel. Tour access is not yet confirmed.

Next task: Check access, research a relevant comparison, and text George the details. Set the task for the follow-up time you agreed.

From the next lead to the next step

Today, you practiced the complete first-conversation process. Take these four actions into your next lead.

- **Recognize the lead.** Know whether you are joining a live buyer or responding to a new request.
- **Start the conversation.** Respond promptly, introduce yourself, and offer a useful appointment.
- **Understand the buyer.** Follow their answers and work through concerns with empathy, questions, and a solution.
- **Agree and follow through.** Summarize the plan, record it in FUB, and do what you promised.

Keep your conversation starters and practice reference handy ■

Use this training after the session

Revisit the explanation, try the exercise, then compare your work.

Find the topic

Use the four sections to return to the action you need. Read the example and the reason for the next step.

Practice again

Answer the scenario before opening its explanation. For a conversation exercise, use the buyer card with a partner, get one specific correction, and retry.

Keep a reference

Download the agent reference for the teaching and examples. Keep practice notes separate from real customer records.

Practice notes

Use fictional details. Write before the example, practice aloud, and retry one specific part after feedback. During a live session, submit through your own login; this printable worksheet is a backup and does not submit for you. The form follows the presenter. Submit before the class moves on, or ask the presenter to return to the question.

What would you do when this lead arrives?

A Zillow request reaches you at 2 p.m. The buyer writes, "I'm at work. Please call at 5 about Cedar Lane."

What would you do, and why? What information would change your answer?

Give your best guess: how quickly should you call?

A 2007 study of web leads found 100 times higher odds of making contact when the first call happened within ____ rather than 30 minutes. Which timeframe fills the blank? Choose an answer, then explain why.

- Within 5 minutes
- Within 10 minutes
- Within 15 minutes
- Within 20 minutes

Choose one, then explain your own response.

Why do you think the response time changes the chance of a conversation?

Respond to a buyer who is at work

A new Zillow inquiry arrives at 2 p.m. The buyer writes: "I'm at work. Please call at 5 about the Cedar Lane home." What should you do next? Choose an answer, then explain why.

- Call now because the new-lead standard is five minutes.
- Text your introduction now, acknowledge the request, and call at 5.
- Let the automated introduction handle the acknowledgment and wait for another reply.

Choose one, then explain your own response.

Explain your choice. What would it communicate to the buyer or help you learn?

How would you open this call?

George requested a tour of Cedar Lane but did not select a time. You can meet Saturday morning or afternoon. Access still needs checking.

What would you do, and why? What information would change your answer?

Which opening serves the buyer's request?

A buyer requested a Zillow tour but selected no time. Both agents introduce themselves. Choose the continuation you would use, then explain what the other version could communicate to the buyer.

- "Before we schedule, tell me about your buying timeline and what you're looking for."
- "I can meet Saturday morning or afternoon. Which works better? I'll check the showing arrangements."

Choose one, then explain your own response.

Explain your choice. What would it communicate to the buyer or help you learn?

What would you ask about needing more space?

The buyer says, "We need more space, but we don't want to leave our neighborhood."

What would you do, and why? What information would change your answer?

Choose the next question you would ask

During a first call, a buyer tells you: “We’re already in town. We need more space, but we don’t want to leave our neighborhood.” Which question would you ask first? Choose an answer, then explain why.

- “How many bedrooms do you need?”
- “What is feeling too tight in your current home?”
- “Would you consider a different neighborhood to get more space?”

Choose one, then explain your own response.

Explain your choice. What would it communicate to the buyer or help you learn?

Practice a short discovery conversation

One person plays a buyer who wants to stay in the neighborhood but needs more space. The other plays the agent, after an appointment has been discussed. Choose a conversation starter, then find out what “more space” means.

What did you learn that “more space” did not tell you?

What feedback did you receive, and what changed on your retry?

Observe the assigned learner and round:

- Uses a relevant conversation starter
- Follows a buyer answer rather than switching to a checklist

Observer / learner / round / one correction / retry:

What would you ask before offering a solution?

The buyer says they are uncertain about the market and hesitate when you offer a visit.

What would you do, and why? What information would change your answer?

A property question may have a concern behind it

A buyer says, “I only wanted to know about the roof. Our last house had an expensive leak, and I’m not ready to schedule anything.” You have not verified the roof information. Which response best acknowledges, explores, and offers relevant help? Choose an answer, then explain why.

- “I understand why you’re cautious. Let’s tour it first so you can see how much you like it.”
- “That sounds frustrating. I’ll send you the roof age when I find it, and you can call me when you’re ready.”
- “After that experience, I understand why the roof matters. What would you need to know to feel comfortable? I can verify that information and we can decide on the next step.”

Choose one, then explain your own response.

Explain your choice. What would it communicate to the buyer or help you learn?

Close a call when the buyer cannot tour yet

A buyer is relocating in two months. They want room for a home office and cannot visit this week. You agreed to email three possible homes and speak Tuesday at 6 p.m. Which closing reflects that agreement? Choose an answer, then explain why.

- “Let’s get a tour scheduled this week so you can decide before you move.”
- “I’ll send some listings. Let me know if anything catches your eye.”
- “You’re moving in two months and need a home office. I’ll email three homes, and we’ll talk Tuesday at 6.”

Choose one, then explain your own response.

Explain your choice. What would it communicate to the buyer or help you learn?

Run a first call and retry one part

Work in trios. The buyer uses an assigned fictional case; the agent responds to what the buyer says. The observer listens for an early invitation, useful follow-up questions and an accurate closing.

What did you learn about your buyer?

What specific feedback did the observer give?

What changed when you tried that part again?

Observe the assigned learner and round:

- Identifies agent, brokerage, Zillow connection and purpose
- Helps with the appointment early while respecting the request
- Asks permission and follows an answer
- Restates priorities and the agreed next action
- Responds usefully to the buyer's question or time constraint

Observer / learner / round / one correction / retry:

Review after your first attempt

Use these explanations to compare your reasoning and correct any gaps. Discussion examples are coaching guidance, not automatically graded answers.

What would you do when this lead arrives?

Acknowledge the request and introduce yourself by text now. Call at five as requested. Save the callback task. The buyer's explicit contact instruction changes the usual prompt-call approach.

Give your best guess: how quickly should you call?

Suggested choice: Within 5 minutes

This is a prediction to start the discussion, not a test of a rule you have already learned. Ask what may change for a buyer while they wait. The research measured time from the web inquiry; our training standard starts when the agent receives the lead.

Within 5 minutes. The study compared calls at five minutes with calls at 30 minutes and reported 100 times higher odds of contact. It studied web leads across six companies, not Zillow buyers specifically. The practical point: respond while the request is fresh.

Respond to a buyer who is at work

Suggested choice: Text your introduction now, acknowledge the request, and call at 5.

Acknowledge now so the buyer knows who will call. The requested time governs the call; the default does not justify interrupting them at work.

“Hi, I’m [your name] with [your brokerage]. I’ll be the agent calling at 5 about the Cedar Lane home. If you have questions before then, you’re welcome to text me.” Call at 5 as requested.

How would you open this call?

Use your name, brokerage, Zillow connection and reason for calling. Invite the visit early with real availability. Then ask and listen. LEAD gives this order so the buyer’s request stays central.

Which opening serves the buyer’s request?

Suggested choice: “I can meet Saturday morning or afternoon. Which works better? I’ll check the showing arrangements.”

An early invitation belongs here because the buyer asked to see the home. This is about order and purpose, not banning useful questions.

The appointment-first opening helps with the request immediately. Asking about readiness before offering the visit can make the buyer feel they must qualify for help. Discovery still belongs in the call, after the early invitation and permission.

What would you ask about needing more space?

Ask what the extra space would let them do. Follow the answer: a quiet work area is different from storage or a larger gathering space. Confirm your understanding before treating a feature as a requirement.

Choose the next question you would ask

Suggested choice: “What is feeling too tight in your current home?”

A useful question follows the buyer’s words and reveals a reason or tradeoff that shapes the search.

“What is feeling too tight in your current home?” This could reveal whether they need bedrooms, work space, storage or something else. Then explore why staying in the neighborhood matters.

Practice a short discovery conversation

Record what you actually learned and changed. Reflection does not prove a coach observed the call.

Choose a relevant starter, explore the current situation, and follow the answer. Learning that the buyer works at the kitchen table points toward a work-space need, not automatically more bedrooms.

What would you ask before offering a solution?

Ask what part concerns them. A fear of choosing the wrong home calls for different help than uncertainty about payment. Offer an action based on the answer and check whether it would help. Avoid predictions or pressure.

A property question may have a concern behind it

Suggested choice: “After that experience, I understand why the roof matters. What would you need to know to feel comfortable? I can verify that information and we can decide on the next step.”

The response recognizes the experience, asks what information would help, and offers to verify it. An invitation can follow when it helps with the concern; it should not skip over the concern.

“After that experience, I understand why the roof matters. What would you want to know before feeling comfortable taking another look? I can verify that information and we can decide on the next step from there.” Then listen. The buyer may need repair records, an answer about age, or help understanding what remains unknown. Do not guess the facts or make the answer conditional on a visit.

Close a call when the buyer cannot tour yet

Suggested choice: “You’re moving in two months and need a home office. I’ll email three homes, and we’ll talk Tuesday at 6.”

A useful next step does not always mean a near-term showing. Reflect the timeline and agreement instead of forcing the tour example onto this buyer.

“You’re planning to relocate in two months and need space for a home office. I’ll email three homes for you to look over, and we’ll talk Tuesday at six about what fits. Is there anything else you’d like me to keep in mind?”

Run a first call and retry one part

Everyone needs a speaking turn and a chance to improve a specific sentence. Peer feedback and reflection are not coach sign-off.

Introduce yourself, help with the request, ask permission, learn location and motivation, and summarize the actual plan. Adapt to the buyer’s question or time constraint. Report the conversation you practiced.

Buyer practice cards

Tour request · a home office

I asked to see the Cedar Lane home. Saturday morning works for me.

Fictional buyer: you rent locally and work at the kitchen table. You need a separate work space and want to stay near your neighborhood. Reveal the reason after a relevant question. You are open to a comparison home. Access has not been checked.

Property question · maintenance

I wanted to know about the roof before deciding whether to tour.

Fictional buyer: surprise maintenance costs concern you. The agent does not have verified roof information. Explain the concern when asked. Prefer a call with verified information before booking; do not agree merely because the invitation is repeated.

Relocation · a later visit

We are relocating in two months. We cannot see homes this week.

Fictional buyer: you need room for a home office. You can review emailed properties and talk Tuesday at six. Share details after relevant questions. The useful next step is planning, not a forced immediate showing.

What each signal means

Connection status is separate from participation. A submitted answer is separate from a completed action. A record check is separate from writing quality. Record who observed a speaking turn and who reviewed it; a peer observation or self-check is not coach sign-off. Practice readiness, quiz certification, and activation remain separate.

After the workshop

Live session: closing the session creates assignments for recall within 24 hours, a fresh case in three days, and coach review in seven days. The session creator owns follow-up across the selected teams unless a different authorized coach was selected. Confirm the displayed session timezone. Due and overdue work appears in Rep; the daily digest links to work due or awaiting review.

Self-paced study: arrange those same checks with a coach. If there has been no relevant client opportunity, use a new fictional case and mark real-work application as not yet observed.

Keep the first attempt and correction. A useful follow-up asks whether the agent can apply the skill in another case.

References

- Your coach and approved team workflow.